

DAMHEE D. HONG

hongdamhee@gmail.com | damhee.com | linkedin.com/in/deedeehong

EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Barbara June 2026

Ph.D., Education | Program Area: Higher Education Policy, Program Evaluation, and Research Methods

- Dissertation: "Not on the Menu: Korean American Students' Experiences of Food and Belonging in Higher Education"
- Committee: Dr. Carolyn Sattin-Bajaj (chair), Dr. Antar Tichavakunda, Dr. Hui-Ling Malone

Northwestern University Dec. 2020

M.S., Higher Education Administration and Policy

- Thesis: "But Where Are You Really From: Korean American Ethnic Identity Development"

University of Hawai'i at Mānoa June 2019

Graduate Certificate, Asian Studies, Inter-Asia Emphasis

University of California, San Diego June 2009

B.A., Political Science – International Relations

CERTIFICATIONS

Artificial Intelligence (AI) in Education Certificate Expected Sept. 2026

University of San Diego

Certificate in Inclusive Teaching Nov. 2024

University of California, Santa Barbara

Graduate Certificate in Asian Studies, Inter-Asia Emphasis June 2019

University of Hawai'i at Mānoa

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Doctoral Dissertation Research Jan. 2025 – Present

UC Santa Barbara | Advisors: Dr. Carolyn Sattin-Bajaj, Dr. Antar Tichavakunda, Dr. Hui-Ling Malone

- Conducted qualitative interviews and thematic coding examining how culturally relevant food experiences relate to belonging among Korean American undergraduates
- Analyzed narratives using CECE and Suda frameworks to explore visibility, inclusion, and cultural engagement
- Prepared dissertation chapters focusing on campus dining, identity, and institutional policy implications

Research Assistant Jan. 2024 – Present

UC Santa Barbara | Advisor: Dr. Carolyn Sattin-Bajaj

- Conducted thematic coding and qualitative analysis of interview transcripts to support ongoing research on immigrant-origin students and teacher preparation
- Developed data visualizations to communicate research findings to academic and policy audiences
- Managed and organized research files and archival materials across shared team platforms

Independent Research Project

Jan. 2022 – Dec. 2023

UC Santa Barbara | Advisors: Dr. Carolyn Sattin-Bajaj, Dr. Tarek Azzam

- Evaluated the provision of interpretation and translation services across 120 California K–12 school district websites, examining how districts communicate families’ rights to language access services
- Identified a systemic gap between federal policy mandates (including Title III of ESSA) requiring language access for limited English proficient families and actual district communication practices
- Developed a rubric to assess language services provision, quality, and accessibility; findings revealed that most districts failed to proactively advertise services, leaving families unaware of their rights
- Presented findings at the 2024 AERA Annual Meeting and as a guest lecture in a graduate education policy course at UCSB

Graduate Research Assistant

Sept. 2021 – June 2023

UC Santa Barbara | Advisor: Dr. Linda Adler-Kassner | Center for Innovative Teaching and Learning (CITRAL)

- Conducted focus group interviews with students across disciplines for a university reaccreditation project; developed coding schemes and conducted qualitative analysis to identify themes in student learning outcomes
- Facilitated collaboration between quantitative and qualitative research teams; collected and archived secondary data sources

AI & EDUCATION EXPERIENCE

Workshop Presenter – AI and Pedagogy

April 2026

2026 Asian Pacific Americans in Higher Education (APAHE) National Conference, Anaheim, CA

- “Beyond the Hype: Critical and Inclusive Uses of AI for Student Success” – facilitated a workshop for 110+ higher education professionals on evidence-based, equity-centered approaches to integrating AI in teaching and learning; multiple institutions requested follow-up workshops after the session

Invited Speaker – AI and Student Learning

Sept. 2025

2025 Black AI: Inclusive Innovation for All Conference, Santa Barbara, CA

- “Using AI as Your Study Buddy” – presented to a diverse audience on ethical, asset-based approaches to AI use for academic success

Poster Presenter – AI and Ethics in Education

May 2025

2025 AI Community of Practice Spring Symposium, Santa Barbara, CA

- “A Study Buddy, Not a Shortcut: An Asset-Based Approach to Cultivating Ethical Usage of AI” – awarded 4th Place, Poster Presentation (\$300)

TEACHING & FACILITATION EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant – ED 125: Schooling in the US

Sept. 2024 – Aug. 2025

Gevirtz School of Education, UC Santa Barbara

- Facilitated weekly discussion sections; provided written and verbal feedback on student work; supported course logistics and communication between students and instructor

Teaching Assistant – Korean Language 2 and 5

Jan. – Mar. 2025

East Asian Languages & Cultural Studies, UC Santa Barbara

- Led language practice sessions and provided individualized instructional support to students at varying proficiency levels

Graduate Teaching Fellow – SKILLS Program

Jan. – June 2024

San Marcos High School & UC Santa Barbara, Santa Barbara, CA

- Co-taught a university-community partnership program serving California public high school students, guiding them through original sociolinguistic research on language, race, power, and identity in their own communities
- Designed and facilitated lessons grounded in social justice education principles, centering underrepresented students as knowledge producers; supported college access motivation among first-generation and underserved youth
- Coordinated between UC Santa Barbara faculty and K–12 school partners to align curriculum with both university and high school learning goals

Teaching Assistant – ED 123: Culture, Development, and Education

Sept. – Dec. 2023

Gevirtz School of Education, UC Santa Barbara

- Supported course instruction on cultural dimensions of learning and development; graded assignments and helped students navigate the Canvas learning management system

Teaching Assistant – SOC POL 332: Economics of the University

Apr. – June 2020

School of Education and Social Policy, Northwestern University

- Facilitated synchronous Zoom sessions for a graduate-level course; monitored and responded to student questions in real time via chat to support instructor-led instruction

English Teacher / Education Volunteer

Apr. 2012 – June 2014

Peace Corps Indonesia – Slahung High School, Slahung, Indonesia

- Designed and taught English curriculum to secondary students (grades 10–12) in a resource-limited international setting; adapted instruction to diverse learner needs and partnered with local teachers to build sustainable classroom practices

English Teacher

July 2009 – Sept. 2010

Veritas Associate English Academy, Daejeon, South Korea

- Taught English to students in grades 3–11 at a private afterschool academy; designed age-differentiated lesson plans and adapted instructional approaches across a wide range of proficiency and developmental levels

HIGHER EDUCATION ADMINISTRATION & STUDENT SERVICES

International Graduate Student Peer Advisor

July 2022 – Aug. 2024

Graduate Student Resource Center, UC Santa Barbara

- Planned and executed 8–12 community-building events annually for international graduate students; managed logistics, budgets, and cross-campus stakeholder outreach including fundraising
- Provided one-on-one mentorship and resource navigation for international graduate students via Zoom and in-person

Graduate Intern – Leadership Institute

Feb. – June 2021

SESP Leadership Institute, Northwestern University

- Coordinated student leader recruitment pipeline from advertising through training and mentorship; supervised a team of 5 student leaders
- Redesigned program marketing materials with an equity focus on first-generation and lower-income students; managed alumni database and communications

Virtual Course Moderator

Sept. 2020 – Mar. 2021

Kellogg School of Management, Northwestern University

- Supported faculty in managing hybrid and virtual learning environments; provided real-time technical support and monitored classroom participation analytics
- Collaborated with instructors to establish best practices for online course delivery

Graduate Career Advisor

Sept. 2019 – July 2020

Medill School of Journalism, Northwestern University

- Provided one-on-one career advising to international graduate students, including resume and CV editing, job search coaching, and identifying funding and employment opportunities
- Authored department newsletters distributed biweekly to 100+ graduate students; analyzed career appointment data to measure program effectiveness quarterly
- Designed and delivered career development and financial literacy workshops via Zoom

Coordinator for Conduct and Community Standards

Nov. 2016 – June 2019

Student Housing Services, University of Hawai'i at Mānoa

- Administered Advocate and Maxient conduct database systems supporting 20+ staff; authored and edited conduct procedure manuals and policies
- Ensured compliance with FERPA, CLERY, and other federal and state regulations; assessed conduct cases and assigned sanctions as appropriate

Student Services Specialist / Admissions Officer

Oct. 2014 – June 2016

International Education Center, Santa Monica College

- Advised and oriented incoming international students on immigration policies and campus life; served as Designated School Official (DSO)
- Supervised and recruited a team of 7–8 international student peer mentors each quarter; evaluated applicants' admission documents for program eligibility

PUBLICATIONS

Sattin-Bajaj, C., Romo-González, L., & Hong, D. (2025). Building Classroom Relationships Through Photovoice: What Immigrant-Origin Students Want Their Teachers to Know and Understand about Them. *The Elementary School Journal*. <https://doi.org/10.1086/735473>

Sattin-Bajaj, C., Barrera Alcazar, J., Hong, D., & Romo-González, M. (2023). An expanded framework for preparing teachers to educate children of immigrant backgrounds. *Teaching and Teacher Education*, 129, 104120. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tate.2023.104120>

PRESENTATIONS & INVITED TALKS

- Hong, D. (April 2026). "Beyond the Hype: Critical and Inclusive Uses of AI for Student Success." Workshop, APAHE National Conference, Anaheim, CA.
- Hong, D. (April 2026). "Not on the Menu: Korean American Students' Reflections on Campus Food and Belonging." Roundtable, AERA Annual Meeting, Los Angeles, CA.
- Hong, D. (April 2026). "Eating Together, Standing Strong: Food, Legacy, and Belonging among Korean American Students." Panel, APAHE National Conference, Anaheim, CA.
- Hong, D., Rodriguez, R. (Nov. 2025). "Navigating the PhD Journey." Guest lecture, ED 200A: Education Proseminar, UCSB.
- Hong, D. (Sept. 2025). "Using AI as Your Study Buddy." Invited speaker, 2025 Black AI: Inclusive Innovation for All Conference, Santa Barbara, CA.
- Hong, D. (May 2025). "A Study Buddy, Not a Shortcut: An Asset-Based Approach to Cultivating Ethical Usage of AI." Poster, AI Community of Practice Spring Symposium, Santa Barbara, CA.

- Hong, D. (April 2025). "Feeding Diversity: Toward Culturally Sustaining School Food." Poster, AERA Annual Meeting, Denver, CO.
- Hong, D. (Feb. 2025). "Interpretation and Translation Service at K–12 School District Websites." Guest lecture, ED 197: Special Topics in Education, UCSB.
- Hong, D. (April 2024). "Provision and Accessibility of Interpretation and Translation Services on K–12 School District Websites." Roundtable, AERA Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, PA.
- Sattin-Bajaj, C., Romo-González, M., Hong, D. (April 2024). "Building Classroom Relationships Through Photovoice." Roundtable, AERA Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, PA.
- Sattin-Bajaj, C., Barrera Alcazar, J., Hong, D., & Romo-González, M. (April 2023). "An Expanded Framework for Preparing Teachers to Educate Children of Immigrant Backgrounds." AERA Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL.
- Hong, D., Su, J., Barrera Alcazar, J., Romo-González, M. (May 2022). "Teacher Preparation for Immigrant-origin Children." GGSE Research Symposium, Santa Barbara, CA.
- Nissen, S., Tolman, S., and Hong, D. (March 2020). "A Crucial Intersection: International Student Career Advising." International Educators of Illinois Annual Conference, Bloomington, IL.

MEDIA & PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

"A Plate of School Food with a Side of Belonging: Scholar Spotlight," *Feminist Food Journal*, Oct. 7, 2025 (Interview). <https://www.feministfoodjournal.com/p/a-plate-of-school-food-with-a-side>

COMMUNITY SERVICE

Korean Translator – Immigration Resource Documents

Oct. 2025 – Present

UC Immigrant Legal Services Center, University of California (Virtual)

- Translated legal and informational documents into Korean to improve access to immigration resources for UC students and families; ensured translations reflect formal legal language and cultural accuracy

Conversation Teacher

Jan. 2023 – June 2024

English Conversation Program, UC Santa Barbara

- Facilitated weekly English conversation sessions for international students and family members; adapted activities to different proficiency levels to ensure inclusive participation
- Nominated for UC Santa Barbara Leadership and Activities Award (SEAL), 2023

Vice President of Communication and Social Media

July 2022 – July 2023

Graduate Student Association in Education, UC Santa Barbara

- Managed communications across email, social media, and department channels; coordinated social programs, town halls, and symposium recruitment efforts including keynote outreach

FELLOWSHIPS & AWARDS

David L. Clark National Graduate Research Seminar Scholar	2026
UCSB Gevirtz Graduate School of Education Dissertation Grant (\$15,500)	2025
4th Place, Poster Presentation – AI Community of Practice Spring Symposium (\$300)	2025
UCSB Gevirtz Graduate School of Education Block Grant Award (\$9,000)	2024
UCSB Gevirtz Graduate School of Education Block Grant Award (\$9,300)	2023

UCSB Gevirtz Graduate School of Education Block Grant Award (\$18,000)	2022
UCSB Gevirtz Graduate School of Education Block Grant Award (\$47,000)	2021

SKILLS

Languages: Fluent in Korean; Conversational in Bahasa Indonesia

AI & Education Tools: Equity-centered and culturally relevant AI pedagogy; ethical AI use for student success; AI Community of Practice; generative AI applications in higher education

Research & Data: Qualitative research methods; thematic coding; Dedoose; Qualtrics; data visualization; descriptive quantitative analysis

Digital & Collaboration: Google Suite, Microsoft Office (Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Publisher), Zoom, Adobe Photoshop; event programming and logistics; newsletter authoring; Handshake

Higher Education Systems: Maxient, Advocate, Banner, fsaAtlas, Odyssey, Canvas (LMS)

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

American Educational Research Association (AERA)	May 2022 – Present
National Association of Student Personnel Administrators (NASPA)	Feb. 2017 – Present
International Educators of Illinois (IEI)	Nov. 2019 – 2021